

July 23: Longhorn becomes Vista

Microsoft announced that its long-awaited and much hyped OS “Windows Longhorn” would now be re-christened Windows Vista. Release dates were still sketchy, and users were tired of hearing about the Windows XP successor; “Release it already!” was probably the single most popular thought that people had when they heard the news of the renaming.

September 12: eBay and Skype

eBay announced its plans to buy Skype—a popular Internet telephony company—for \$2.6 billion (Rs 10,400 crore). After buying online payment company PayPal in 2002, this move gave eBay the advantage of controlling the most popular resources in two very huge fields—eCommerce (eBay and PayPal) and Internet voice communication (Skype).

2006**Core 2, Zune, And Google Buys YouTube**

January 5: Intel's Core

Intel unveiled the Core series of processors. This was seen as the beginning of the end of AMD's short-lived dominance in terms of CPU price and performance because Intel's Cores started winning benchmarks again. Within a few months (read on to find it), Intel went even a step further by introducing the Core 2 series of CPUs, thus re-stamping their dominance of the CPU market, and ending AMD's short stint at the top of the performance charts.

March 31: The first HD-DVD player

Toshiba launched the world's first commercially available HD DVD player, and thus began the HD wars. With everything visual already moving to high definition—camcorders, display devices, movie titles, etc.—the war between the two most popular HD disc formats, HD-DVD and BD (Blu-ray Disc), was given a shot in the arm with the release of hardware players. Later, in May of the same year, Toshiba launched the first HD-DVD-capable PC drive.